

UNKNOWN

A True Story of Compassion, Neglect, Pain — and Humanity

“They called him mad. I chose to see a human being.”

This is a true story based on real experiences. The person in this story is referred to only as “Unknown” to protect his identity and dignity. Some circumstances are described from personal observation and recollection; where exact details were uncertain, they are presented cautiously.

THE MAN WHO SAT QUIETLY BY THE ROAD

After I began living in Bard, I started noticing a young man who frequently appeared around the streets, crossings and shops. He seemed to be in his early twenties, perhaps younger. People often called him “mad” or mentally challenged. But when I watched him carefully, I saw something different: an innocent human being trying to survive in a world that had largely stopped noticing him.

He would sometimes walk from one place to another. Sometimes he carried utensils or a sack. Sometimes he stood quietly in front of a shop. If the shopkeeper felt compassionate, he received something to eat. If not, he was chased away. He did not create trouble. He did not demand much. Often, he simply sat quietly somewhere for hours.

He had learned the basic rules of survival. When it rained, he knew where to take shelter. At night, he often slept near a Hanuman temple or around shops where he could remain relatively protected.

A SIMPLE DECISION: “HE SHOULD NOT SLEEP HUNGRY”

I began thinking: whatever his mental condition may be, he is still a human being. If I can help, why should I not make sure that he gets food at least three times a day?

So I started looking for him. Around ten in the morning, again around two or three in the afternoon, and again around ten at night, whenever I found him, I tried to give him food. Sometimes I carried food in my bag. Sometimes I would ask a samosa seller, milk shop or another nearby shop what he could eat.

He usually did not explain what he wanted. So I would give him simple choices. "Do you want this or that?" He would choose one option, and I would arrange that food for him.

At that time I was working as an engineer for a private company at NTPC. By God's grace, I earned enough to manage my needs and also help others. My involvement with animal rescue and street welfare was continuing as well.

I did not think I was doing something extraordinary. I simply felt that if a hungry person was standing in front of me, I should not walk away.

THE WOUND

One night I noticed that his foot had a wound. I tried to help. I sprayed medicine on it and sometimes applied ointment. He would allow me to treat the wound from a distance, but he would not take oral medicine. He was frightened and would move away whenever I came too close.

Sometimes I could not find him for a day. Sometimes I would see him the following night. Meanwhile, the wound was becoming worse.

Then one day I saw that the wound had become deep. The leg was swollen, and maggots had appeared. At that moment I knew that simply spraying the wound was no longer enough. He needed proper medical attention.

THE FIGHT TO GET HIM TO A HOSPITAL

That night I treated the wound as much as I could. The next morning I searched for him. When I tried to take him for treatment, he resisted and ran away. I asked people around me to help, explaining that if we left him like this, he could permanently lose the use of his leg.

The following day I again treated the wound. The maggots appeared to have died after treatment, but the wound was badly swollen and needed proper care. With the help of others, we finally managed to get him to medical attention.

He did not want to enter the hospital. He was scared and resisted. So I contacted the few volunteers I knew. They contacted others. One person called another, and gradually a small chain of compassionate people came together.

Eventually, he received treatment.

HEALING — AND THEN ANOTHER TRAGEDY

For a while, things seemed to improve. He began walking again. We hoped that perhaps the worst was over.

But later we discovered that he had been sleeping near a large lodging hotel or restaurant. We learned that someone associated with the place had apparently struck his injured leg. The result was devastating: his leg was badly fractured, swollen, and visibly deformed.

When the volunteers who had previously helped him saw what had happened, they immediately informed me: "Please come quickly. Something has happened to him."

I was working at the time. But I left my work and went to help. This has sometimes caused difficulties in my professional life. When I become deeply involved in a case where a vulnerable human or animal needs immediate help, it becomes difficult for me

to simply continue working as if nothing happened.

He was eventually taken by ambulance for further treatment at NMCS Hospital. Someone accompanied him, and he was admitted for care.

A QUIET PLACE TO SURVIVE

Later, we visited to make sure he was receiving proper care. Gradually, we heard that after treatment he was staying near a Hanuman temple close to the railway station. There, people were giving him food.

We considered bringing him somewhere else, but he appeared relatively comfortable and safer there. He had found a place where people recognized him and food was available. So, for the time being, we left him there.

I still do not know what the rest of his life will look like. I do not know his family, his full history, or how he came to live on the streets. I only know what I witnessed: a young, vulnerable human being trying to survive without the protection that most of us take for granted.

THE STORY DID NOT END WITH “UNKNOWN”

My experiences during the COVID-19 lockdown in Visakhapatnam were similar in another way. I saw several people living on the streets who appeared mentally challenged, abandoned or otherwise unable to care for themselves.

I approached the police and requested that something be done for them. Unfortunately, the situation was not properly understood or acted upon. So, as far as I could, I began helping with food.

A woman I knew, Siddheshi Madam, was doing social-service work in Visakhapatnam. During lockdown, she helped arrange food for people and animals. Whenever I needed assistance, I approached her. If food could be arranged, I would take it and distribute it.

I used to cover roughly a five-kilometre area, checking on vulnerable people and animals. I would provide food in the morning and again at night. Later, government teams began distributing food during the day as well. When they saw me working, I told them where some of the vulnerable people were staying. They began reaching those locations too.

Even after government assistance started, I continued checking personally. Were they receiving food? Was someone sick? Had anyone disappeared? If I noticed a problem, I reported it so that attention could be given.

HUMANITY DOES NOT HAVE A SPECIES

During those days I helped many animals as well — street dogs, cows, pigs and other living beings who happened to cross my path. I never believed that compassion should be reserved for one species.

A hungry person is hungry. A wounded dog is in pain. A frightened cow feels fear. A vulnerable human being deserves dignity. Different bodies, different minds, different needs — but life is life.

We often use words such as “mad”, “useless”, “stray”, “burden” or “problem”. Sometimes these words allow us to stop seeing the person or animal behind the label.

But what if the person we call “mad” is someone's son? What if he once had a mother who waited for him? What if he once dreamed of a normal life? What if his only mistake was being born into circumstances where nobody was able or willing to protect him?

THE QUESTION I WANT TO LEAVE WITH YOU

I am not telling this story because I believe I did something extraordinary. I am telling it because I want us to ask ourselves a difficult question:

“If he were my own brother, would I leave him alone on the street?”

We cannot solve every problem. We cannot rescue every person. We cannot feed every animal. But we can refuse to become indifferent.

Sometimes humanity begins with something very small: buying one meal, giving clean water, calling someone who can help, reporting an injured person, protecting an animal, or simply refusing to laugh at someone who cannot defend himself.

A MESSAGE TO THE NEXT GENERATION

Children are the future of society. If we teach them only how to earn, compete and succeed, but do not teach them compassion, then our progress will remain incomplete.

Teach children to look at animals as living beings, not commodities. Teach them not to mock a mentally challenged person. Teach them to notice hunger, injury, loneliness and fear. Teach them that helping someone who cannot repay you is one of the purest forms of humanity.

And if our choices can reduce unnecessary suffering — including choosing a compassionate, plant-based way of living — we should at least have the courage to learn, think and make informed choices.

BE VEGAN. BE HUMAN.

SAVE HUMANITY. SAVE THE WORLD.

**This story is dedicated to every unknown person
sleeping under a shop shutter, every hungry human
being quietly waiting for a meal, and every wounded
animal waiting for someone to notice.**

**Sometimes, the greatest act of humanity is simply
noticing.**

THE REALITY BEHIND THE STORY



HE IS NOT "MAD" HE IS HUMAN

They called him **"Crazy"**, we called him **UNKNOWN**

He roamed on the streets alone, polite, innocent, hungry... Sometimes he asked for food, sometimes he just sat in silence. Most of the time, he slept near a Hanuman Temple.

A TRUE STORY OF COMPASSION THAT CHANGED A LIFE

"The measure of a society is how it treats those who can do nothing for it in return."

MY PROMISE TO HIM

- Three times a day I made sure he never slept hungry.
- I cleaned his wounds, applied medicine, tried to heal his pain.
- He didn't speak much, but his eyes said "Thank You".

A KIND HEART • A SMALL STEP CAN CHANGE A LIFE

A JOURNEY OF PAIN, CARE & HOPE

1. A WOUND THAT HURT

One day I saw a deep wound on his foot. It was swollen and full of maggots. He ran away when I tried to take him for treatment.

2. TREATMENT

With the help of volunteers, we convinced him and took him to the hospital. He was treated and slowly got better.

3. AGAIN, CRUELTY

While he was recovering, someone at a hotel/guest house beat him badly. His leg was fractured and badly swollen.

4. HOSPITAL & HEALING

We rushed him to the hospital again. He received proper treatment. Slowly, he healed... body and spirit.

5. A SAFE PLACE

Now he stays near a Hanuman Temple. He gets food, some love, and lives in peace. He is safer now.

NOT JUST ONE, MANY UNKNOWN SOULS

During the lockdown in Visakhapatnam, I saw many mentally challenged people on the streets. The police ignored. But we didn't.

- We fed them.
- We checked on them.
- We got help from kind people and an NGO.
- We made sure no one slept hungry.

WHAT WE CAN LEARN

- Don't judge a person by his looks or behaviour.
- Kindness is not charity, it is our duty.
- A little care can heal a broken life.
- Be the reason someone believes in humanity.

MESSAGE TO THE NEXT GENERATION

The world doesn't need more rich, smart or talented people. The world needs more kind, compassionate and responsible humans.

BE THE CHANGE. BE THE HOPE. BE HUMAN.

BE VEGAN. BE HUMAN. SAVE HUMANITY. SAVE THE WORLD.

RESPECT ALL LIFE | FEED THE HUNGRY | HEAL THE HURTING | SPREAD LOVE | CREATE A KINDER WORLD

COMPASSION COSTS NOTHING, BUT ITS IMPACT LASTS FOREVER.

Photograph and awareness poster supplied for this true-story document